

LATEST SMARTPHONES FROM THE FEATURED BRANDS

	Samsung Galaxy S3	Huawei Ascend G300	LG Optimus 4X HD	Lava XOLO X900	Karbons A9
Operating system	Android 4.0	Android 2.3	Android 4.0	Android 2.3	Android 2.3
Display	12.1 cm super AMOLED capacitive touchscreen	10.2 cm WVGA IPS screen	11.9 cm HD-IPS LCD capacitive touchscreen	10.1cm LCD display	9.6 cm capacitive touchscreen
Resolution	720 x 1280 pixels	800 x 480 pixels	720 x 1280 pixels	1024 x 600 pixels	480 x 800 pixels
Processor	1.4 GHz	1 GHz cortex-5 processor	1.5 GHz Quad core-Tegra3 processor	1.6 GHz Intel processor	1 GHz processor
Camera	8 MP	5 MP	8 MP	8.1 MP	5 MP
Memory	16 GB	4 GB	16 GB	16 GB	1 GB
Storage	64 GB	32 GB	32 GB	32 GB	32 GB
WIFI	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
3G	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Battery life	Up to 770 hours	Up to 24 hours	Up to 686 hours	Up to 336 hours	Up to 200 hours
USB Connectivity	MicroUSB, v2.0	Yes	MicroUSB, (MHL), v2.0	Yes	Yes



S N Rai, co-founder and director, Lava Mobile



Shashin Devsare, executive director, Karbons Mobile



Kelvin Lim, director for ASEAN and India, Sophos

should make the user suspicious about the legality of the download."

With security turning out to be a major concern for Android smartphone users, do handset vendors provide any additional layer of security? Victor Shanxin, president, Huawei Device India, a brand that offers cloud services to its smartphone users, elucidates, "Huawei is committed to work with partners to ensure mobile device security, and build a secure and reliable platform for mobile devices to take full advantage of the Android

of smartphones infected tripled in the second quarter of 2012. Quite some time back, Android smartphone users became casualties to fake versions of the photo-sharing app Instagram, which imposters used to run up huge mobile phone bills. And downloading a fake app can be hazardous, warns Kelvin Lim, director - ASEAN and India, Sophos, an IT security firm. "If a user downloads a fake app, a backdoor will be created to let cyber offenders make their way to sensitive data stored on the device. It also facilitates future downloads of malware onto the device, which may lead to data theft through the installation of key loggers," says Lim. Offering a piece of advice for Android smartphone users, he adds, "Always download apps only from the vendor's official app store. Read the terms and conditions before downloading them, and do not just click 'Next' blindly. A verification code in most cases requires acknowledgment. The absence of this

security framework. Our device security is divided into four levels—the safety of the equipment, data security, network security and application security. This four-level architecture guides the formulation of the security policy. We provide data security, storage and access, support for data backup (cloud and local backup), remote device back functions (remote location, remote control, mobile phone alarm, call forwarding, the remote device lock, remote data wipe, etc) — all of which ensure data security in the smartphones."

Android Apps: On the march

As Android works on the open source system, it gives users innumerable choices to devise customised apps according to their needs. Those at Samsung, the numero uno brand in smartphones, believe that consumers today are looking at buying mobile devices that will empower them with